ISFT

INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF FINANCIAL TRAINING

BESPOKE QUALIFICATION

ISFT Award in Applied Financial Markets Trading

Trade with the forces that move the market.

4	8	Level 3	Online
UNITS	CREDITS	AWARD	SELF-PACED

www.derivion.in

Centre: Derivion International Private Limited (trading as ISFT) · Course code 1131234



OCN London BESPOKE

WHY THIS QUALIFICATION

Understanding *why* markets move is what separates a trader from a gambler.

This qualification builds that understanding: fundamental analysis, central bank policy, and a structured, disciplined approach to trading around scheduled market-moving news.



01

Practitioner-designed

Authored by the centre's Head Educator, drawing on 40+ years of professional trading experience across global markets.

02

Built on real market events

Case studies drawn from real central bank decisions and major economic data releases, not textbook theory.

03

Standardised and accredited

Delivered under OCN London (course code 1131234), with a defined credit value, level and external quality assurance.

04

Applied, not just informational

Learners construct and evaluate a real written news-trading plan against an actual scheduled economic release.

WHO IT IS FOR

The next step after the basics.

For learners who have completed a Level 2 introduction to financial trading, or hold equivalent foundational market knowledge, and want to build applied analytical skills relevant to active trading.

Level 2 completers

Ready to build on the fundamentals of the market.

Active market followers

Comfortable with financial news and data.

Applied traders in training

Want a disciplined, evidence-based process.



Prior learning

There is no formal barrier to entry — these are recommendations.

- Completion of the Level 2 Award in Introduction to Financial Trading, or equivalent market knowledge
- Comfortable engaging with financial news and basic economic data
- A device with internet access to reach the Learning Management System

WHAT YOU WILL BE ABLE TO DO

Three applied skills this qualification builds.

01



Read the fundamentals

Interpret GDP, inflation and employment data, and understand how each moves a specified market.

UNIT 1

02



Track central bank policy

Understand how a central bank's tools and decisions ripple through currency, bond and equity markets.

UNIT 2

03



Trade scheduled news with a plan

Build a structured, risk-aware trading plan around a scheduled news event, then evaluate it against the outcome.

UNITS 3 AND 4

PROGRAMME AT A GLANCE

The numbers behind the programme.

A focused, applied qualification: 4 units, 8 credits, delivered fully online at Level 3.

4	8	3	6–10
UNITS	CREDITS	LEVEL	WEEKS TYPICAL

QUALIFICATION	ISFT Award in Applied Financial Markets Trading
OCN LONDON COURSE CODE	1131234
AWARDING ORGANISATION	OCN London
CENTRE	Derivion International Private Limited (trading as ISFT), Centre ID 160472
DELIVERY	Online, self-paced via Derivion Academy LMS
ACCREDITATION / REVIEW	Accredited 13/08/2026 · Reviewed 13/08/2027

HOW YOU LEARN

Learn online, at your own pace.

Delivered entirely online through Derivion Academy. There is no fixed timetable: learners typically finish within 6 to 10 weeks.



01

Study

Video instruction and written study materials, available on your own schedule.

02

Explore

Real market case studies: central bank decisions and major economic data releases.

03

Assess

An online MCQ for each unit, auto-marked through the LMS.

04

Apply

A written news-trading plan and post-event evaluation, assessed by the Head Educator.

WHAT YOU NEED

- Computer, laptop, tablet or smartphone
- An internet connection to the LMS
- Comfort reading financial news and data

YOUR LEARNING JOURNEY

Four units, one applied outcome.

Each unit is worth two credits and builds toward reading and trading real market events.

1

EB1/3/LR/011

Fundamental Analysis and Economic Indicators

The categories of data that move markets — GDP, inflation, employment — and how to read them.

2 credits · Level 3 · Online MCQ

2

EB1/3/LR/012

Central Banks and Monetary Policy

How central bank objectives and tools translate into moves in currency, bond and equity markets.

2 credits · Level 3 · Online MCQ

3

EB1/3/LR/013

Applied News Trading and Market Strategy

Risk and opportunity around scheduled news, and how to structure a trading plan for it.

2 credits · Level 3 · Online MCQ

4

EB1/3/LR/014

Economics for Financial Traders

The macroeconomic picture, applied to a real scheduled release, with a written plan and evaluation.

2 credits · Level 3 · MCQ + written task

UNIT 1 · EB1/3/LR/011

Fundamental Analysis and Economic Indicators

The categories of fundamental data traders use, and how key economic indicators move a specified market.

2 credits | Level 3 | Online MCQ



Principles of fundamental analysis

- Identify the main categories of fundamental data used by traders
- Identify how fundamental analysis differs from technical analysis

Key economic indicators

- Explain the purpose and significance of GDP, inflation and employment data
- Analyse how a given economic indicator release could affect a specified market

Applying fundamental analysis

- Interpret a simple set of economic data to form a view on likely market direction
- Justify a trading decision using fundamental analysis reasoning

INDICATIVE CONTENT

Fundamental vs technical analysis | GDP, CPI, employment data | Reading an economic calendar | Case studies of indicator releases

UNIT 2 · EB1/3/LR/012

Central Banks and Monetary Policy

How central banks operate, and how their policy decisions ripple through currency, bond and equity markets.

2 credits | Level 3 | Online MCQ



The role of central banks

- Explain the core objectives of a central bank, e.g. RBI, US Federal Reserve
- Describe the main tools of monetary policy available to a central bank

Policy decisions and markets

- Explain how a change in interest rates can affect currency, bond and equity markets
- Identify the likely market reaction to a hypothetical central bank policy statement

INDICATIVE CONTENT

Role and objectives of central banks | Interest rate policy | Quantitative easing / tightening | RBI framework alongside global central banks

UNIT 3 · EB1/3/LR/013

Applied News Trading and Market Strategy

How volatility behaves around scheduled news events, and how to build a structured plan for trading them.

2 credits | Level 3 | Online MCQ



Trading around scheduled news

- Explain the risks and opportunities associated with trading economic news releases
- Describe how volatility typically behaves before and after a major news release

A structured approach to planning

- Construct a simple trading plan for a scheduled news event, including entry, risk and exit considerations
- Evaluate the outcome of a news-based trade scenario against the original plan

INDICATIVE CONTENT

- News trading risk and opportunity
- Volatility behaviour around releases
- Building a news-event trading plan
- Post-trade evaluation

UNIT 4 · EB1/3/LR/014

Economics for Financial Traders

The macroeconomic picture behind the market, applied to a real scheduled release in a written plan and evaluation.

2 credits | Level 3 | MCQ + written task



Basic macroeconomic concepts

- Explain the relationship between economic growth, inflation and interest rates
- Describe the economic concept of supply and demand as applied to a financial market

Global economic relationships

- Explain how trade balances and capital flows can affect currency values
- Analyse how an economic development in one country or region could affect Indian markets

Applying analysis to a real event

- Construct a written trading plan from a real, recent scheduled economic release, including entry, risk and exit considerations
- Evaluate the actual market outcome against the original plan in a written post-event analysis

INDICATIVE CONTENT

Macroeconomic fundamentals | Supply and demand in markets | Trade balances and capital flows | Global economic interconnection with Indian markets

UNIT 4 · APPLIED TASK

Plan the trade. Then mark your own work against it.

Unit 4 ends with a written news-trading plan built from a real, scheduled economic release — then a post-event evaluation of how it actually played out.

800–1,200

words, written news-trading plan and evaluation

Assessed by the Head Educator against a published marking brief.

NEWS-TRADING PLAN

Written scenario and post-event evaluation

Real scheduled release

Chosen from an upcoming economic calendar event

Entry, risk and exit plan

A structured plan constructed before the release

Post-event evaluation

The actual outcome assessed against the original plan

ASSESSMENT

How you're assessed.

Each unit closes with an online MCQ, auto-marked on the LMS. Unit 4 adds a written news-trading plan and evaluation.



EB1/3/LR/011

1 **Fundamental Analysis and Economic Indicators**

Online MCQ · 25 questions · 50 minutes · 70% pass mark

EB1/3/LR/012

2 **Central Banks and Monetary Policy**

Online MCQ · 25 questions · 50 minutes · 70% pass mark

EB1/3/LR/013

3 **Applied News Trading and Market Strategy**

Online MCQ · 25 questions · 50 minutes · 70% pass mark

EB1/3/LR/014

4 **Economics for Financial Traders**

Online MCQ · 25 Q · 50 min · 70% · + Written plan · 800–1,200 words

MCQ: recognition level

Where criteria say explain, describe or compare, you select the correct answer from plausible alternatives.

Written task: application

Criteria that ask you to construct, apply, analyse, evaluate or justify are assessed through the Unit 4 written task.

QUALITY AND STANDARDS

Standards you can rely on.

Assessment is quality-assured at every stage, and the qualification is reviewed every year.

1

Set

Activities are set internally by tutor/assessors so learners can meet the learning outcomes and assessment criteria.

2

Moderated

Assessed evidence is internally moderated at the centre, unless it is computer-assessed.

3

Externally verified

An OCN London External Quality Assurer moderates externally.

4

Reviewed every year

The Head Educator reviews the qualification annually, informed by learner feedback, IQA assessment-outcome analysis and OCN London Quality Engagement reports.

WHERE THIS LEADS

Your next step in financial markets.

On completion, learners may progress to other Level 3 Awards in the suite:

- **Introduction to Financial Markets**
- **Introduction to Futures Trading**
- **Introduction to Risk Management**
- **Introduction to Behavioural Psychology in Trading**

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